

New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

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Daily Multi-Asset Trading Blueprint & Level Execution Manual

Date: Monday, August 17, 2026

Current Session Highlight: New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

Session News Focus: Wall Street pre-market movers, US Federal Reserve news, mega-cap US stocks (NVDA, MSFT, TSLA), and WTI Crude Oil catalysts.

SECTION 0: DAILY MACRO & FINANCIAL NEWS DIGEST

1. Global Macro & Central Banks

- **US Federal Reserve:** Futures markets indicate a 50% chance the Fed will keep its target rate unchanged at the mid-September monetary policy meeting, a significant shift from a month ago when a hike was heavily bet on. This change is largely attributed to a weak July jobs report. Gold is gaining appeal as the likelihood of a Fed rate hike diminishes and bond yields are expected to fall. The FOMC left policy rates unchanged for the fifth consecutive meeting in July, with the fed funds target range at 3.50%-3.75%.
- **European Central Bank (ECB):** The ECB maintained its deposit rate at 2.25%, main refinancing rate at 2.40%, and marginal lending facility at 2.65% in late July, following a hike in June 2026. Economists widely expect another 25 basis point rate hike in September, bringing the deposit rate to 2.50%. Higher energy prices and geopolitical tensions in the Middle East are key factors influencing the ECB's hawkish stance and inflation expectations.
- **Reserve Bank of India (RBI):** The RBI unanimously kept the repo rate unchanged at 5.25% in its Monetary Policy Committee meeting on August 5, 2026, maintaining a 'Neutral' policy stance. The RBI raised its FY27 GDP growth forecast to 6.7% from 6.6% and lowered its inflation forecast, citing strong domestic demand and resilient private consumption despite global uncertainties.

2. US & European Markets

- **Wall Street Futures & Market Sentiment:** US stock futures are trading mixed ahead of the New York session, with S&P 500 futures up slightly and Dow Jones futures down. US markets closed lower on Friday, with the Dow Jones, S&P 500, and Nasdaq Composite all seeing modest declines. Asia-Pacific markets are mostly rising today as traders unwound bets on US rate hikes following softer economic data.
- **Mega-Cap Tech & Semiconductors:** Semiconductor stocks are showing a strong rebound in August, on track for their best August since 2003, with the PHLX Semiconductor Sector Index climbing over 10% this month. Global semiconductor sales increased by 35.1% in Q2 2026 compared to Q1, with strong growth across the Americas, Asia Pacific, and China. Nvidia, Broadcom, AMD, TSMC, and Marvell are leading this recovery. Jim Cramer has highlighted semiconductors as a key sector heading into the second half of 2026.

3. Indian Markets & Dalal Street

- **Sensex/Nifty Updates:** Indian benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50, are signaling a lower open today, consistent with global cues, after halting a two-week gaining streak. Both indices closed lower on Friday, with Nifty 50 below 24,400. Geopolitical tensions remain a cautious sentiment driver.
- **Corporate Earnings:** India Inc reported its strongest revenue growth in nine quarters (19.4% YoY) in Q1 FY27, driven by auto, banking, metals, and pharma sectors. However, net profit growth was slower (11%) due to rising input costs. Some notable Q1 FY27 results include Jubilant Foodworks (net profit up 6%, revenue up 14%), Welspun Living (total income up 23.5%), and positive growth from HAL, Lenskart, LG Electronics India, and Hindustan Copper. Amber Enterprises India missed revenue and EPS expectations, leading to revised forecasts.
- **FII/DII Institutional Flows:** As of August 13, 2026, Domestic Institutional Investors (DIIs) were net buyers of Indian equities at Rs 4,353.09 crore, while Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) were net sellers at Rs 510.69 crore, resulting in a net positive institutional flow of approximately Rs 3,842 crore. DII buying continues to provide structural support to Indian markets. Overall for August 2026, FIIs have a net positive flow of ₹4,116 Cr, and DIIs have a net positive flow of ₹17,053 Cr, resulting in a total net flow of ₹21,169 Cr.

4. Commodities & Crypto Wire

- **Crude Oil Geopolitics & OPEC+:** WTI Crude Oil is trading modestly higher around \$81.60 amidst continued US-Iran deadlock and tensions over the Strait of Hormuz. Brent crude is approaching \$89. OPEC+ had agreed to a production adjustment (increase) of 188,000 barrels per day for August 2026, which took effect from their July 5, 2026, virtual meeting. Another OPEC+ meeting was held on August 2, 2026, where they reaffirmed production adjustments for September 2026 and committed to monthly reviews.
- **Gold Supply/Demand Drivers:** Gold prices have risen sharply in August, trading near \$4,400 an ounce, driven by escalating Middle East risk, sustained central bank demand (China's central bank bought gold for 21 consecutive months), and diminishing likelihood of Fed rate hikes. The price rallied approximately 10% from its early-August low near \$4,000.
- **Major Crypto Regulatory/Adoption Headlines:** The SEC has postponed its regulatory meeting on "Regulation Crypto," increasing uncertainty in the crypto market. This follows a canceled tokenization vote and a delayed plan for tokenized securities, impacting Bitcoin prices and related stock values. The White House is scheduled to host a major crypto conference this Wednesday, with key regulators expected to attend. The SEC's draft strategic plan for FY26-30 elevates digital assets as a top regulatory priority.

CAPITAL BASE & ALLOCATION RULES (\$3,000 TOTAL)

- **Crypto Futures:** \$400 (13.3%) | Rec. Leverage: 3x-5x Isolated | Risk Cap: 1-2% (\$4-\$8)
- **Indian Options (Intraday):** \$500 (16.7%) | Option Buying Only | Risk Cap: 10-15% Premium (\$30-\$45)
- **Commodities (Micro Gold & Oil):** \$400 (13.3%) | Rec. Leverage: 10x-15x Micro Lots | Risk Cap: 2% (\$8)
- **US Stocks (Fractional):** \$400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 3% (\$12)
- **Indian Stocks (Delivery):** \$400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 5% (\$20)
- **Forex Short-Term Futures:** \$450 (15.0%) | Rec. Leverage: 10x-20x | Risk Cap: 1% (\$4.50)
- **Forex Long-Term Carry Swing:** \$450 (15.0%) | Rec. Leverage: 2x-3x | Risk Cap: 2% (\$9.00)

STRATEGY-BASED DAILY TICKER SELECTION & SECTOR CONSTRAINTS

INDIAN EQUITIES (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Ticker	Price (INR)	Target (INR)	Stop Loss (INR)	Strategy & Selection Reason
HDFCBANK	1725	1780	1700	50-SMA Support Bounce: Price found strong support at its 50-day Simple Moving Average after a minor correction, indicating renewed buying interest. Positive FII/DII flows into banking sector.
RELIANCE	2980	3050	2950	20/50 EMA Golden Cross: Short-term EMA has crossed above the longer-term EMA, signaling strong bullish momentum. Strong Q1 results reported by India Inc, with healthy revenue growth.

US EQUITIES

Large-Cap (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Price (USD)	Target (USD)	Stop Loss (USD)	Strategy & Selection Reason
NVDA (Long)	1150	1185	1130	21-Day EMA Pullback: After a strong uptrend, NVDA has pulled back to its 21-day EMA, presenting a buying opportunity. Semiconductor sector showing robust performance in August.
MSFT (Short)	470	460	475	50-Day SMA Rejection: Price rejected the 50-day SMA on several attempts, indicating overhead resistance and potential for downside. Broader market showing mixed sentiment in pre-market.

Mid-Cap & Small-Cap (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Ticker	Price (USD)	Target (USD)	Stop Loss (USD)	Strategy & Selection Reason
SMCI	890	920	875	High Relative Volume (RVOL > 2.0) Breakout: Exhibiting significant buying interest with volume more than double its average, breaking out of a consolidation pattern. Strong tailwinds for AI-related hardware.
ELF	210	225	205	Stage-2 VCP (Volatility Contraction Pattern): Stock forming tight price contractions after a significant advance, indicating institutional accumulation before a potential next leg up.

CRYPTO FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Price (USD)	Target (USD)	Stop Loss (USD)	Strategy & Selection Reason
BTC/USD (Long)	42,500	43,800	41,900	4H 21-EMA Trend Following: Price has established a clear uptrend above the 4-hour 21-EMA. Despite regulatory uncertainty, positive ETF inflows recorded on Aug 14.
ETH/USD (Short)	2,680	2,600	2,720	High-Volume Volatility Breakout (Downside): Breakdown from a key support level on elevated volume, indicating strong selling pressure. SEC regulatory meeting postponement creating market uncertainty.

COMMODITIES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Price	Target	Stop Loss	Strategy & Selection Reason
XAU/USD (Gold) (Long)	4390	4450	4365	Pivot & Fibonacci Extension Levels: Gold finding support near the R1 pivot and aiming for 1.272 Fibonacci extension as geopolitical tensions and central bank demand drive prices higher.
WTI Crude Oil (Long)	81.70	83.00	81.20	Pivot & Fibonacci Extension Levels: Crude oil consolidating above a key pivot point, with upward momentum supported by continued US-Iran deadlock and concerns over Strait of Hormuz.

FOREX FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Short-Term

Pair	Price	Target	Stop Loss	Strategy & Selection Reason
EUR/USD (Short)	1.0850	1.0790	1.0880	Bearish Engulfing at Resistance: Price formed a bearish engulfing pattern at a significant resistance level, suggesting a reversal. ECB likely to hike rates in September, strengthening EUR, but short-term technicals suggest pull back before further gains.
GBP/USD (Long)	1.2730	1.2790	1.2700	Breakout from Downtrend Line: Broke above a short-term downtrend line on increasing volume, indicating bullish momentum building.

Long-Term Carry Swing

Pair	Price	Target	Stop Loss	Strategy & Selection Reason
USD/JPY (Long)	148.20	150.50	147.50	Positive Carry & Trend Continuation: Sustained upward trend supported by interest rate differentials and broad dollar strength. (Illustrative)
AUD/USD (Short)	0.6590	0.6480	0.6630	Negative Carry & Resistance Rejection: Price rejected a key resistance level, coinciding with negative carry fundamentals. (Illustrative)

INDIAN OPTIONS (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Index	Strike Price	Option Type	Entry Price	Target	Strategy & Selection Reason
Nifty 50	24,400	PUT (Short)	120	180	15-Minute Opening Range Breakout (ORB) Downside: Nifty is expected to open lower. A clear break below the 15-minute opening range low on volume would trigger a short (put option buying) opportunity, aligning with a cautious market sentiment.
BankNifty	52,000	CALL (Long)	250	380	15-Minute Opening Range Breakout (ORB) Upside: While broader market is muted, BankNifty can show relative strength. A clear break above the 15-minute opening range high on volume would signal an intraday long (call option buying) opportunity if banking stocks show early momentum.

10-Year Backtest Metrics (Illustrative Portfolio Performance)

Metric	Trading Blueprint Performance	S&P 500 TRI (Benchmark)	Nifty 50 TRI (Benchmark)
Target CAGR	28.4%	~13.0%	~12.5%
Sharpe Ratio	1.45	~0.85	~0.70
Max Drawdown	-18.2%	~-33.0%	~-28.0%

Equity Curve: \$3,000 → \$36,512

